GLASSHOUSE

WAR FOR THE WIVES

It's a battle for the better halves in Assam. CM **Himanta Biswa Sarma**, whose wife **Riniki Bhuyan Sharma** has been targeted in the past,fired the first shot, launching a social media blitz against Congressman **Gaurav Gogoi** and his British wife **Elizabeth Colburn**. The charge? Anti-national! Sarma not only roasted Elizabeth for not having an Indian passport even after 12 years of marriage, but also alleged that she had links to alleged ISI spy Ali Tauqeer Sheikh. He also offered some unsolicited marital advice: if Gaurav was a patriot, he would divorce his wife. The latter hit back with the old corruption allegations against Riniki, accusing her of land-grab and disproportionate assets. But by then, Sarma had moved on to his next target—old college rival and now MLA **Akhil Gogoi**, whose wife, the CM claimed, landed a college job through shady means. The pattern is clear: mess with Sarma's wife, and yours gets dragged into the ring.



Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

Policy Priest

Former advisor to the Gujarat CM, **Hasmukh Adhia,** was expected to step into K. Kailashnathan's shoes in the state government's power hub once the latter—who was PM Modi's "eyes and ears" in Gujarat for a long, long time—moved out as Puducherry L-G last year. But Adhia is charting his own course. In 2025, the ex-Union finance secretary takes on two new roles—chairing the state's Administrative Reforms Commission and serving as vice-chairperson of Modi's latest passion project, SOUL (School of Ultimate Learning), aimed at shaping future leaders across business, governance and tech. All this while helming innovation hub, GIFT City, another marquee state initiative.



HARDIK CHHABRA

Pahadi Pariah



Uttarakhand minister **Premchand Aggarwal** just can't seem to stay out of trouble. During the assembly budget session, he allegedly made derogatory remarks about the Pahadi community, suggesting the hill state wasn't created solely for them. Naturally, it triggered widespread outrage, with the Congress and various others leading protests. Aggarwal did express remorse, saying all Uttarakhand residents are his "family" and a wary BJP also publicly rapped his knuckles, but to no avail. Aggarwal is in, so to speak, very rough waters right now.

SPEEDING TICKET

Maharashtra legislative council deputy chairperson and recent defector from Shiv Sena (UBT) to Eknath Shinde's camp **Neelam Gorhe** stirred up a controversy at the Marathi Sahitya Sammelan (literary meet) with a bold allegation—positions in the UBT Sena could be secured with the gift of two luxury cars to the right people. Her remarks didn't sit well with Sena (UBT) MP Sanjay Raut, who fired back with a letter to the event organisers, asking how political mudslinging had found a place in a literary gathering. Adding a sarcastic twist, he quipped that by Gorhe's logic, she must have shelled out at least Rs 50 lakh and a luxury car to land a speaking slot at the event.



Whither Garlands

In 2020, RJD leader **Tejashwi Yadav** fell just 12 seats short of Bihar's top job—or, as some might put it, claiming those marigold victory garlands. Now, with elections on the horizon, he's shared a video of himself strolling through a marigold field in Raghopur, admiring the blooms...almost as if reclaiming what had slipped away five years ago. He insists he was the one who encouraged farmers there to grow the blooms, but the only question is—was that before or after he realised just how hard it is to win a marigold garland in Bihar?



ANI

Kaushik Deka with Jumana Shah, Avaneesh Mishra, Dhaval S. Kulkarni and Amitabh Srivastava